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12TH ANNIVERSARY EDITION

# Building People Building Businesses Building a Brighter Tomorrow

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## Pankaj J Harwansh

FOUNDER & EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR
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# FROM THE EDITOR'S DESK

## *The Rise of* Navi Mumbai

Every city has a story. Navi Mumbai's story is one of vision, opportunity and people who chose to build something new.

Today, it is a city full of energy, home to entrepreneurs, professionals and businesses that are growing, connecting and creating opportunities every day. And within this larger story is a community with a story of its own: **BNI Navi Mumbai**

For years, our members have come together week after week, not just to exchange business, but to build something far more meaningful; **relationships rooted in trust**. Referrals have become opportunities, opportunities have become growth, and business connections have often become lasting friendships.

***BNI RISE was born from this spirit.***

Our first edition, launched this Diwali, is a celebration of light, new beginnings and the people who make our business community shine. It brings together the businesses, knowledge, experiences and stories of our members, while opening a window for the wider business community to discover what makes BNI Navi Mumbai special.

This edition will reach every Navi Mumbai member and guests visiting our chapters and region during the coming quarter. And with 100,000 digital copies being shared with business owners across Navi Mumbai. The stories and businesses of our members will reach far beyond our BNI family.

I am deeply grateful to our Founder and Executive Directors for believing in this vision, and to every member who contributed through an advertisement article, stories or simply their encouragement. Every contribution has helped give **RISE** its first heartbeat.

As we celebrate this beginning, I look forward to bringing you our New Year Edition in January 2027.

*This is more than a magazine.*
*It is our members. Our stories.*
*Our community. And together, our RISE.*

Zenia D'souza

**Zenia D'souza**
Editor-in-Chief, BNI RISE
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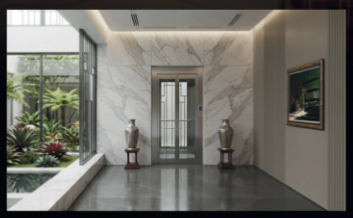

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# FOUNDER'S FOREWORD

## *The Corner Table*

**Pankaj J Harwansh**

Founder & Executive Director,
BNI Navi Mumbai

Twelve years ago, I sat at a corner table in a restaurant with zero connections in Navi Mumbai and one conviction: that word of mouth, done right, could build a business community impacting thousands of business owners. Today, that corner table has grown into an ecosystem of 700+ business owners transacting over ₹3,000 crores in business — friend introducing friend, one trusted referral at a time.

Along the way, we created history: the world's first twin chapter launch, the world's second twin launch, the world's largest single chapter launch with 141 members, and 22 months as the world's top-ranking BNI region. None of it was built alone.

Gratitude to our **founding members**, who trusted an idea before it had proof — thank you for the leap of faith. To every **member, past and present, every Director (Support, Launch, Training), every Ambassador, and our tireless Regional Support Team** — this ecosystem is yours as much as mine.

This magazine, **RISE**, was born from a simple belief: that our members' stories deserve a stage bigger than a weekly meeting. It will carry their successes, their insights and their businesses to every member and visitor across our chapters, and to **100,000** business owners across Navi Mumbai in digital format — opening doors through articles, advertisements and infomercials that put your business in front of an entire city.

My deepest gratitude to **DC Zenia D'souza,** who turned this idea into reality, to **Rutuja Deshmukh**, our head graphic designer, for giving it a face, and to every member, directors who contributed an article to this first edition.

Looking ahead, I am equally excited about what's next for our community. **BNI Yuva,** our new initiative to nurture entrepreneurship in young minds aged 10 to 20, is already showing us what the next generation of business owners looks like. We are launching **Navi Mumbai Angels,** a dedicated ecosystem to back our region's startups, and gearing up for Members Day this December. As Navi Mumbai rises to become one of India's smartest cities, the business opportunities ahead for our community and every one of our members have never looked brighter.

Navi Mumbai itself is rising — new infrastructure, new industries, new opportunities at every corner. Let **RISE** be the voice of the business community built to thrive in it. Together, let's build Navi Mumbai's most powerful business community, one member one referral at a time.

With gratitude,

Pankaj J Harwansh

> *"Together, let's build a stronger business community for a brighter Navi Mumbai."*

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# Aseem Gokarn Harwansh

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# THE ART OF POSSIBLE

## *The journey from self-employed to entrepreneur is rarely linear.*

The journey from being self-employed to becoming an entrepreneur is rarely linear. It is challenging, overwhelming and, at times, lonely. It demands resilience to navigate uncertainty, humility to learn, courage to reinvent and determination to keep moving forward.

As entrepreneurs, we strive to add value to our products, services and businesses. But equally important is the value we add to ourselves. Because behind every business is a person—and as the business grows, we must grow with it.

Every entrepreneurial journey has its highs and lows, moments of achievement and moments that test our resilience. What makes the journey meaningful is having people around us—people who inspire, challenge, support and walk alongside us.

## *BNI Navi Mumbai is that community.*

It brings together entrepreneurs, professions, experiences and perspectives, united by one philosophy—Givers Gain®. Here, we don't just exchange referrals; we exchange knowledge, ideas, encouragement and possibilities. We learn, share, absorb and evolve.

That, to me, is the strength of this community. BNI doesn't just help you grow your business; it helps you grow as an entrepreneur and, ultimately, as a human being.
As the Executive Director of BNI NaviMumbai, I take pride in being part of this community. Today, 700+ entrepreneurs across 17 chapters come together to build relationships, create opportunities and generate over ₹3,000 crore of business.
Yet, the power lies beyond the numbers—in the trust, collaboration and relationships that make them possible.
When diverse minds come together with generosity, possibilities multiply. An introduction can open a door. One conversation can spark an idea. One relationship can transform a business.
This is the power of collaboration.
The Art of Possible is not somewhere in the future. It is being created daily, by each of us.

## *And the next possibility could begin with you.*

*Welcome to the journey.*
*Welcome to BNI Navi Mumbai.*

**Dr Aseem Gokarn Harwansh**
Executive Director, BNI Navi Mumbai

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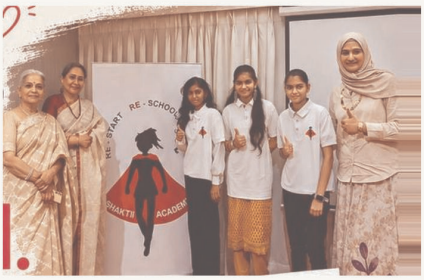

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# FROM VISION TO IMPACT

Every business begins with a simple hope: that the right person will find us at the right time. BNI exists to make that happen far more often than chance would allow.

Welcome to Rise, the magazine of BNI Navi Mumbai, a region defined by energy, enterprise and opportunity.

Founded in 1985 by Dr. Ivan Misner, BNI today brings together over 355,000 members across more than 11,800 chapters in 77 countries. Its philosophy, Givers Gain®, is simple: when we help others grow, we grow too. As of August 2026, BNI India is the largest country in the network, with over 75,000 members across 1,577 chapters.

Navi Mumbai's journey began in 2014 with the launch of two chapters. Twelve years later, we stand 17 chapters and 700+ members strong, with members having generated over ₹3,000 crore in business.

Our journey has been marked by milestones: a second twin launch in 2017; a five-year celebration in 2019 featuring a three-day mega expo with 5,000+ footfalls; and, in 2020, one of our chapters becoming the world's largest. During the Covid years, our members generated over ₹450 crore in business, demonstrating the strength of trust-based networking.

More recently, a 2024 business fair featuring Aman Gupta, BNI Yuva in 2025, and this year's Business Opportunities Day and four industry-focused Conclaves have continued to expand our community. Our Health & Wellness event, The Wellness Array, along with philanthropy and charity initiatives, reflects our commitment beyond business.

Our goals are clear: 1,000 members and ₹5,000 crore in business generated by December. Achieving them means stronger referrals, meaningful one-to-ones and, above all, a culture of giving.

Rise celebrates this journey—and invites you to be part of what comes next, together, with shared purpose.

*Jennifer Dias*

**ASST. AREA DIRECTOR,**
**BNI NAVI MUMBAI**

> *"When we help others grow, we grow too."*

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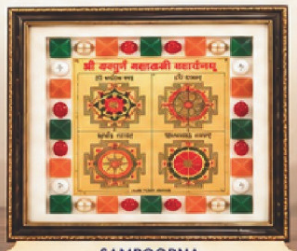

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# Navi Mumbai's Moment

*Forces reshaping the region, and the business opportunities they create*

THE GATEWAY

## Navi Mumbai International Airport: A New Global Gateway

Navi Mumbai has entered a new era with its international airport now operational. More than a transport project, it is an economic catalyst that strengthens the city's position as an independent business destination. Its impact will be felt across hospitality, logistics, aviation services, retail, food and beverage, mobility, facility management, real estate and professional services. With Atal Setu improving connectivity and new road and rail networks developing around Panvel and Ulwe, businesses can reach a much larger market, faster. For BNI members, this creates a powerful referral economy: construction, interiors, travel, transport, technology, security, recruitment, finance, legal and events can all benefit from the ecosystem growing around the airport.

REAL ESTATE

## The Next Growth Corridor

Ulwe, Panvel, Kharghar, Taloja, Dronagiri and New Panvel are becoming one connected growth corridor. The airport is an important catalyst, but Atal Setu, metro development, highways, rail connectivity and NAINA are also reducing travel barriers and opening new residential and commercial possibilities. The opportunity goes well beyond buying and selling: new development creates demand for architecture, construction, finance, legal services, interiors, security, healthcare, hospitality and education, while offices, logistics and retail follow. Investors must still weigh location, approvals, infrastructure timelines and developer track record before committing.

TALENT ECONOMY

## Building the Talent Pipeline

Infrastructure attracts investment, but talent sustains it. Navi Mumbai has a strong education base across Kharghar, Nerul and surrounding nodes, spanning management, engineering, medicine, design, law and science. Students create demand for housing, food, mobility and services, while graduates feed a steady talent pipeline. Businesses can partner through internships, live projects, mentoring and recruitment programmes, which is especially valuable for small and medium firms struggling to attract and retain young professionals. Good education also draws families to relocate, strengthening residential and commercial demand.

The track record speaks for itself. From its first chapter in 2014, BNI Navi Mumbai has grown to 17 chapters, 700+ members and a business ecosystem worth over ₹3,000 crore, rising alongside the city it serves. Infrastructure creates business, and business runs on referrals. As Navi Mumbai rises, those who build strategic relationships today will be best placed to shape, and share in, what comes next.

INDIA'S DATA-CENTRE POWERHOUSE

Behind India's digital transformation lies infrastructure few people see, and Navi Mumbai has become one of the country's most important locations for it. The region combines proximity to Mumbai's financial base with fibre connectivity, subsea cable access, land and power, as cloud, AI, payments and streaming push up demand for computing capacity. The opportunity reaches far beyond IT firms: data centres need specialised construction, electrical and cooling systems, renewable energy, fire safety, cybersecurity, recruitment and round-the-clock facility management. The digital economy, in short, has a large physical supply chain.

THE BIG PICTURE

## From Satellite City to Economic Centre

The biggest Navi Mumbai story of 2026 is not one project but the convergence of many. A global airport, better connectivity, new real-estate corridors, Mumbai 3.0, data centres and a growing talent base together can change the city's identity, from a planned satellite created to decongest Mumbai into a major business destination in its own right. Every large project creates hundreds of smaller business requirements, from hospitality and logistics to finance, legal, interiors and engineering. Networking becomes especially powerful in periods of rapid change, because opportunities rarely exist in isolation; they exist in ecosystems.

**Pankaj J Harwansh**
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# Navi Mumbai *is no longer* Mumbai's Backup Plan

By Sudeep Kumar

**Founder-CEO, Sirius Star Enterprise Technologies**
**Senior Director Consultant, BNI Navi Mumbai**

**When I opened Sirius Star in Vashi in 2009, clients said Navi Mumbai was "far." Now they call to ask if there's office space in our building.**

Look at what's arrived in the last three years. Atal Setu cut the drive to South Mumbai. Navi Mumbai International Airport started commercial flights on 25 December 2025. NTT, Sify and CapitaLand now run data centres along the Airoli Mahape Rabale belt, and L&T Vyoma has broken ground on a 40 MW ai ready facility.

Then there's the diamond story. GJEPC and MIDC are building India Jewelry Park at Ghansoli, planned as the country's largest. India's diamond and jewelry trade is building its next home.

The housing data shows where people are moving. According to Square Yards, Navi Mumbai's share of MMR residential sales has risen from 16% to 22%, and it accounted for 21% of the region's new launches in the first half of 2026.

So, I'll say it plainly. I think Navi Mumbai is the fastest-growing business market. I'm betting Sirius Star's ₹200 crore goal on it anyway.

What does this mean for a business owner here? Every new office near the airport needs laptops and a firewall. Every jewelry unit needs to protect design files. Every new flat in Ulwe needs an interior designer and a CCTV installer. Every data center needs electricians, caterers, lawyers and transport. Demand is arriving faster than local businesses are getting organized to meet it.

That's where BNI comes in. Across 17 chapters and about 700+ members in Navi Mumbai, business owners are building referral networks this growth will run on.

Pick a chapter. Show up. Then see what this city does for your business.

> *"Navi Mumbai is the fastest-growing business market."*

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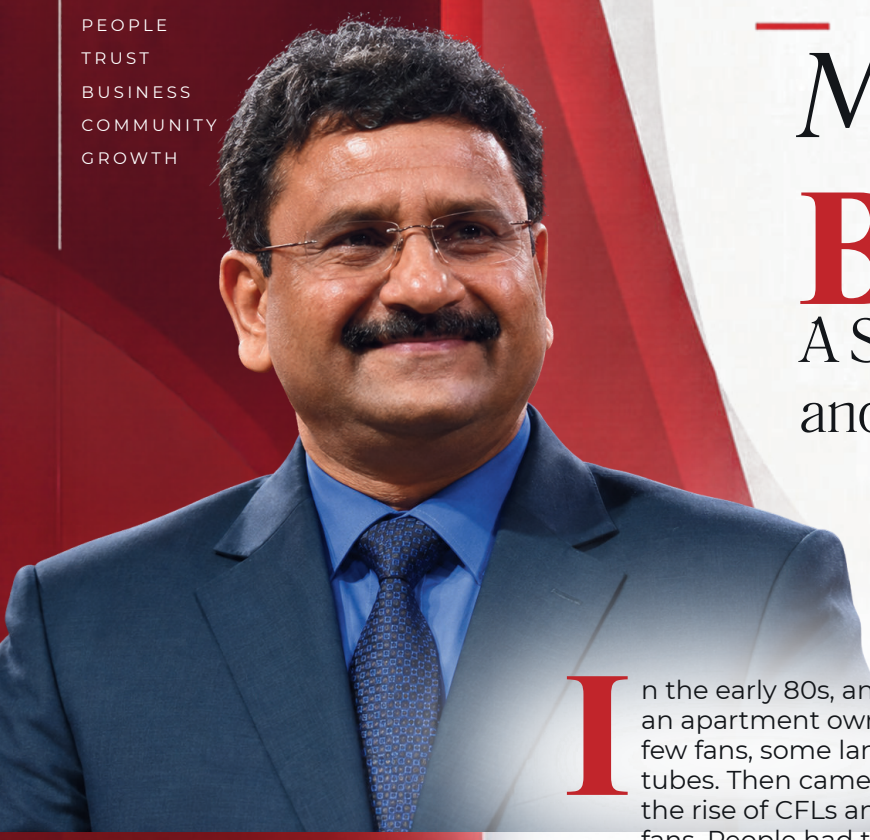

# My Journey in BNI

## A Story of Light, Leadership and Lasting Relationships

> *"Business becomes a means to establish long term relationships."*

In the early 80s, an order from an apartment owner meant a few fans, some lamps and tubes. Then came the 90s and the rise of CFLs and decorative fans. People had the opportunity to highlight every showpiece, match fans with themes and with rising incomes, hire interior designers. The advent of LEDs meant that a new world opened up with opportunity for experimentation. Recalibration opened up a whole new refurbishment market.

### 2017

It was around this time, in 2017, that my BNI Journey began. The first thing that I picked up was, "Specific is Terrific". Working to train a whole room of people to represent your business posed its own set of questions. Doing 121s with diverse people opened up both, queries and new opportunities. We learnt to deal with Interior Designers and Architects in BNI, we built a new business stream, moving from being generalists (wholesalers) to specialists (customized solutions).

### Nine Months In

Nine months into my membership, I was appointed President. Energizing and motivating a group of business owners was very different from my professional days. It changed my perspective from being a Leader focused on mere goals to a holistic approach of being a Leader of thought.Building Trust makes people align easily with your vision. Business becomes a means to establish long term relationships. In the last decade, our client retention is well above 95%.

### August 2026

In August 2026, I was awarded a Community Builder Award for my work as Green Club President of BNI Navi Mumbai. This was possible due to a team who trusts me and believes in the vision of BNI Navi Mumbai as a global leader. BNI has helped transform me and my business and given access to some of the most wonderful people I have ever met.

***Grateful for that.***

**Shashikant Damani**
FOUNDING MEMBER
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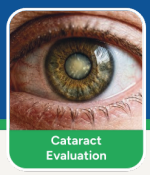
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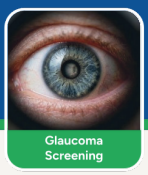
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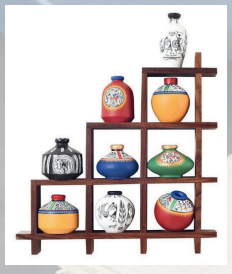

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| | | |
|---|---|---|
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| 19 | Umesh Sharma | Vriddhi |
| 18 | Rahul Joshi | Harmony |
| 17 | Afreen Sayed | Bandhu |
| 17 | Sonia Kuralkar | AMN |
| 16 | Parag Rathod | Grandiose |
| 16 | Sharad Kumar | Inesh |
| 16 | Vinay Samota | Construct |
| 15 | Darshan Chitlange | AMN |
| 14 | Gejo Plachery | Epic |
| 14 | Nilesh Bhatt | AMN |
| 14 | Shriram Prajapati | Epic |
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| 13 | Shashikant Damani | Grandiose |
| 12 | Jigar Thakkar | Epic |
| 12 | Santosh Pokale | Inesh |
| 12 | Shubhangi Adate | Symphony |
| 12 | Venkatesh Iyer | Knights |
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| 9 | Raymond Goveas | Industrial |
| 9 | Saba Quraishi | Bandhu |
| 9 | Sudeep Kumar | Inesh |
| 9 | Sunil Balchandani | Construct |
| 8 | Aashish Dangda | Inesh |
| 8 | Abhay Maniyar | Inesh |
| 8 | Amanpreet Gill | Knights |
| 8 | Amit More | Grandiose |
| 8 | Haresh Shah | Harmony |
| 8 | Kamlesh Pawar | Knights |
| 8 | Kavita Bothra | Inesh |
| 8 | Mohiuddin Khan | Inesh |
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| 7 | Deepak Mishra | Inesh |
| 7 | Devanand Malathu | Inesh |
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| 7 | Mamta Jaju | Inesh |
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| 7 | Nuzhat Jahan | Grandiose |
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| 7 | Rakesh Nikam | Bandhu |
| 7 | Ravi Ganguly | Grandiose |
| 7 | Sagar Malwade | Bandhu |
| 7 | Surekha Ichake | Grandiose |
| 7 | Uttam Patil | Inesh |
| 7 | Vijayalaxmi Iyer | AMN |
| 6 | Aby Mathew | Colossal |
| 6 | Amar Nikam | Vriddhi |
| 6 | Anagha Bhagat | Knights |
| 6 | Dhruva Choksi | Inesh |
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# Sustainability Business in Navi Mumbai

In architecture, we were taught that ancient cities were protected by fortification walls, moats, and gateways. This was because all administrative, economic, and cultural life thrived within them. Mumbai, as India's financial capital, has functioned similarly.

Navi Mumbai was created to decongest this fortified city. It was planned development on the outskirts to provide better living, with planned residential sectors, transportation, local commercial growth, reliable public services, and most importantly, open spaces and green lungs. The core objective was sustainable growth.

And that is exactly where our business opportunity lies today.

Under Maharashtra's UDCPR, the government is actively pushing sustainable development. Any project that goes for recognized Green Building Certification like IGBC or GRIHA gets direct financial incentives - primarily through additional FSI and non-FSI benefits for green features. Developers in Navi Mumbai, 'this is not just about the environment; it is pure business sense. **Extra FSI means extra saleable area and direct additional revenue**, achieved simply by building more responsibly.

While the world is fighting to reduce its carbon footprint, we're still fighting for better living. Interestingly, the solution to both is the same: **Green Buildings.**

Choosing green certification not only gives you FSI benefits today but also creates a healthier, future-ready asset for generations. Imagine if all our schools, hospitals, and offices in Navi Mumbai were green - it would mean healthier occupants and lower operational costs for everyone.

This growth also creates a huge ripple effect for all of us in this room. More green buildings mean more business for solar systems, water-saving fixtures, energy-efficient lights and HVAC, sustainable materials, and many other trades.

*Architect Rashmi Kolatkar & Architect Hrushikesh Kolatkar: Environmental Consultant*

IN SHORT

**Let us align our entire BNI supply chain towards one powerful goal:**

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# Navi Mumbai

## The Infrastructure Powering the Next Real Estate Frontier

Over the last two years, Navi Mumbai has moved from long-term promise to operating reality, no longer driven by announcements, but by delivery, and the numbers reflect it.

**AMIT VAKIL** : SENIOR DIRECTOR
CONSULTANT - SUPPORT
HEAD BNI EVENTS BNI NAVI MUMBAI

REAL ESTATE & INFRASTRUCTURE EXPERT

### Connectivity — The Foundation

The NMIA began commercial operations in December 2025, scaling toward a planned capacity of 90 million passengers annually. The Mumbai Trans Harbour Link has cut South Mumbai's commute to Navi Mumbai to roughly 40 minutes. A ₹5,575 crore Metro expansion strengthens links between Belapur, Kharghar, Taloja and Pendhar, while the upcoming Metro Line 8, the "Golden Line," will connect the airport directly to Mumbai's suburban rail network.

### Business Infrastructure

Navi Mumbai has emerged as one of India's most active data center corridors. Amazon Web Services has committed approximately $430 million to a 473-megawatt campus near Taloja, joining an Airoli-Rabale-Mahape belt home to STT GDC, L&T, Sify and Colt, part of a state policy targeting 1.5 gigawatts of digital infrastructure capacity, positioning NAINA as a national tech hub.

### Healthcare

A new tertiary hospital was commissioned in Nerul in early 2026, and Apollo operates a 500-bed facility near the Mumbai-Pune Expressway, signalling institutional confidence in the region.

### NAINA and the Next Growth Ring

West of the airport, CIDCO is developing NAINA as a planned smart city, extending growth already seen in Ulwe and Panvel.

### Real Estate Impact

Kharghar has appreciated over 105% in five years, and the wider belt is up roughly 22% since 2021. CIDCO has floated tenders for a 100-to-120-acre Kharghar Corporate Park modelled on BKC.

### Referral Networks

This scale of infrastructure creates opportunity for contractors, consultants and service providers. Networks like BNI help owners capture this ripple effect across an ecosystem.

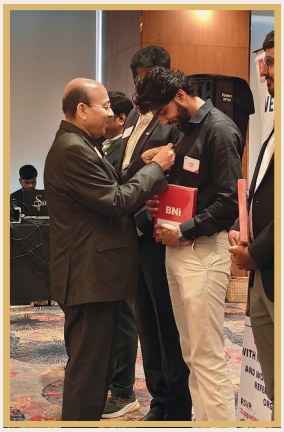
*Stronger infrastructure today. Greater possibilities tomorrow.*

# Recent Events

MORE PEOPLE.
MORE BUSINESS.
MORE IMPACT.

# Recent Events

MORE PEOPLE.
MORE BUSINESS.
MORE IMPACT.



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# Why Baby Teeth Matter

"They're just baby teeth — they'll fall out anyway" is a common myth. Primary teeth hold space for permanent teeth, guide jaw growth, and help children chew and speak properly. Untreated cavities may affect the permanent tooth developing underneath.

## When Should the First Visit Happen?

A child should visit the dentist within six months of the first tooth erupting, or by the first birthday, whichever comes first. Early visits help children become familiar with the dental environment and can make future visits more comfortable.

## Common Problems

Early Childhood Caries is common and may be associated with prolonged exposure to milk, juice, or sugary liquids, particularly through bedtime bottles. Thumb-sucking beyond age three may affect bite alignment. Teething discomfort and minor injuries are also common.

## Habits That Protect Little Smiles

- Under 3 years: brush twice daily with a rice-grain smear of fluoride toothpaste.
- Ages 3-6: use a pea-sized amount twice daily, with supervision.
- Avoid bedtime bottles of milk or juice; water is recommended.
- Limit sticky, sugary snacks between meals.
- Ask your dentist about fluoride varnish and sealants.
- Schedule dental check-ups every six months.

## Making Dental Visits Positive

Children benefit from gentle, age-appropriate communication, patience, and techniques such as "tell-show-do." At Pulse Dental Clinic, our all-women dentist team and calm environment are designed to make dental visits comfortable for children. A healthy childhood smile can support good oral health for life.

*If your child has not had a dental check-up recently, consider scheduling a visit at Pulse Dental Clinic.*

## Pulse Dental Clinic

*"We create smiles!!"*

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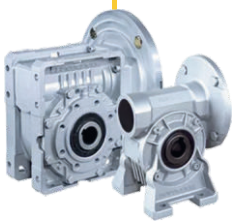

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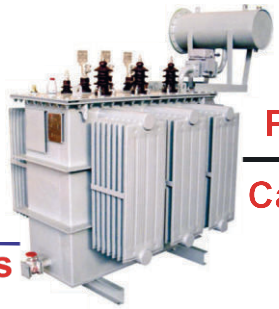

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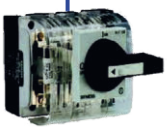

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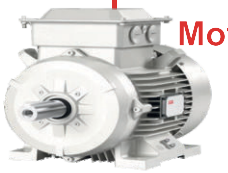

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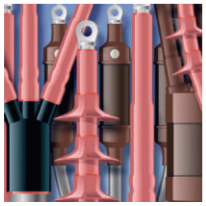

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# My Journey in BNI – A Decade of Growth

*"It is never too late to reinvent how you do business."*

Walking into **BNI Navi Mumbai** in early 2016 at the age of 58, the vibrant energy of driven, younger professionals was both intimidating and infectious. Yet, the core philosophy of **Givers Gain** instantly appealed to me. Initiated by Executive Director **Pankaj Harwansh**, I embarked on a remarkable decade-long journey that completely redefined my approach to networking.

As a proud member of the **BNI Vriddhi** chapter, I quickly learned that growth extends far beyond commercial metrics; it is a shared cultural ethos of personal development and community contribution. BNI's mathematically sound, accountability-driven referral system builds deep trust. Through active one-on-ones, members have generated massive business volumes, expanding local enterprises and creating financial stability. In complete alignment with the law of reciprocity, the ecosystem helped my own office furniture manufacturing enterprise, **Ergocomp Plastic India Pvt Ltd** (a joint venture with **Ivars S.p.A.**). BNI provided highly qualified, warm introductions that fuelled substantial business growth.

True immersion required moving beyond passive attendance and stepping into active leadership. Serving as **Chapter President** and **Secretary-Treasurer** provided an exhilarating masterclass in executive skills. I learned that true leadership is not about authority, but about facilitating the success of independent, ambitious business owners. It taught me diplomacy, empathy, and how to run high-energy, impactful meetings. Serving as a **Gold Club Member** and **Power Team Coordinator** kept me highly visible and continuously pushed me out of my comfort zone.

The ultimate test of this brotherhood came during the **COVID-19 pandemic**. While many businesses struggled, BNI members weathered the storm collectively, ensuring a safe landing through mutual support. BNI does not just build networks; it creates an elite safeguard of trusted professionals who stand by you when life's storms arrive.

*My journey proves it is never too late to reinvent how you do business. If you show up and give unconditionally, the right environment will always foster resilience, leadership, and lifelong growth.*

*-NIMISH GANDHI*
*FOUNDING MEMBER*
*BNI NAVI MUMBAI*

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WED, 23 OCT 2024 | VOL. 11 ISSUE 587
NAVI MUMBAI TIMES
PEOPLE | PROGRESS | A BRIGHTER NAVI MUMBAI
Festive Spirit Lights Up Navi Mumbai
Tradition, Togetherness and a Brighter Tomorrow
Navi Mumbai is all set to welcome the festive season with renewed joy, as families come together to celebrate traditions, strengthen bonds and support local businesses.
From vibrant neighbourhood markets to illuminated streets, the city is embracing the spirit of togetherness, pride and new beginnings.
A City That Shines Together
As festivities return, Navi Mumbai continues to shine as a city of opportunities, culture and community spirit.
Jewellery Remains a Timeless Part of Our Festivities
Across generations, jewellery has been more than an adornment — it is a symbol of love, heritage and new beginnings. This festive season, families in Navi Mumbai are choosing pieces that celebrate tradition while looking ahead to a brighter tomorrow.
Heirlooms for New Beginnings
Skilled Hands, Brighter Futures
Local artisans continue to keep the rich legacy of Indian jewellery alive.
Local Businesses Add New Sparkle to Festive Markets
From handcrafted designs to modern collections, Navi Mumbai's jewellers are offering a wide range of exquisite pieces this season, blending timeless craftsmanship with contemporary styles.
FESTIVE SHOPPING TIPS
• Choose timeless designs
• Invest in quality
• Support local jewellers
• Celebrate meaningful traditions
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# Navi Mumbai 2026: Are We Living Healthier?

Navi Mumbai is growing—new buildings, better connectivity and faster lives.
But after more than a decade of practising here, I often ask: **are we becoming healthier as our city grows?**

In my OPD, I see how our changing environment and lifestyle affect our health. Dust, construction and air pollution can aggravate allergies, asthma, cough and wheezing.

But it's only about the air outside.
We sit more, move less, spend longer hours on screens and often compromise on sleep. Obesity increases the risk of obstructive sleep apnoea. Allergies can disturb sleep; poor sleep leaves us tired and less active; pollution can make breathing harder.

> ***These problems are more connected than we realise.***

Perhaps a healthy city shouldn't be measured only by its roads, buildings and connectivity, but also by how well its people breathe, move and sleep.

## As Navi Mumbai grows, can we grow healthier with it?

### DID YOU KNOW?

**AQI >200**
recorded in parts of Navi Mumbai in early 2026.

**49.4%**
of Indian adults are estimated to be Insufficiently physically active.

**~104 million**
working-age Indians are estimated to have obstructive sleep apnoea.

**Dr. Bhumika Madhav**
MBBS, MD (Pulmonary Medicine), DPSM
Trained in Sleep Medicine, Allergy & Immunotherapy

Consultant Pulmonologist,
Sleep & Allergy Specialist

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# Is your *dream big* enough?

BIGGER VISION.
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The world is talking about the India story — the fastest-growing large economy, Viksit Bharat, and a ray of hope in an uncertain global environment. The next 20 years could be India's golden period, supported by strong demographics and economic momentum. Within this larger story, **Navi Mumba**i stands out as a place where exceptional opportunities are emerging.

With world-class investments in infrastructure, technology, logistics and education, Navi Mumbai is creating the ideal conditions for business growth. The rise of the US and China was driven not only by large corporations, but also by thousands of ambitious family-run businesses and SMEs that scaled into major enterprises.

## *"Is your dream big enough?"*

If you run a ₹5 crore business in 2026, can you imagine building a ₹20,000 crore enterprise by 2046?

These numbers are not unrealistic. The foundation for such growth rests on three things: **Vision, Strategy and Community.** Around us are many examples of business owners who have achieved exponential growth over the past decade.

As a business coach, I meet many SME owners who either do not dream big enough, do not know the path to growth, or do not leverage the power of a strong business community. In doing so, they risk missing the opportunities created by the India and Navi Mumbai growth stories.

Fortunately, Navi Mumbai has access to talented coaches, world-class business frameworks and strong peer communities. A good coach helps struggling entrepreneurs find the right strategy and tools, while helping successful ones expand their vision. Combined with the support of a committed community, this can enable businesses to become the best version of themselves.

**Arun Rao**
*Business Coach - TTS Coaching*
*Senior Director Consultant - Training BNI Navi Mumbai*

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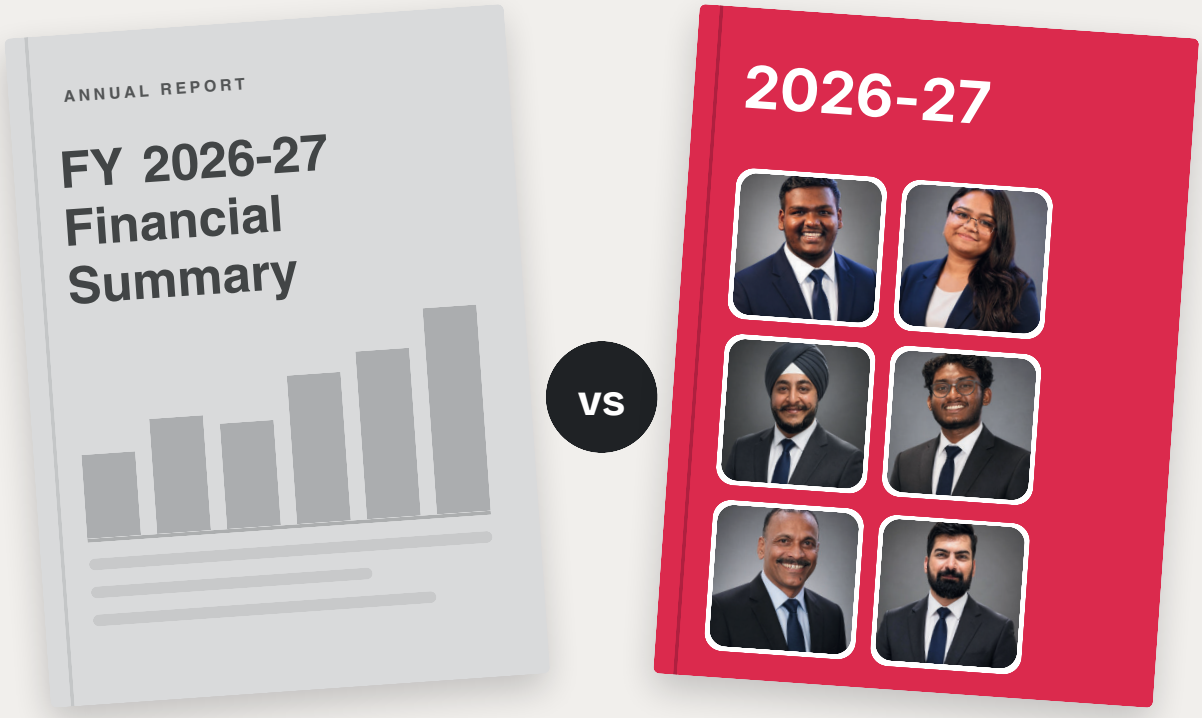


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# COFFEE WITH ED

## *Where New Members Find Their Footing*

For every new member who joins BNI Navi Mumbai, the first few weeks can feel like stepping into a room full of established relationships. Coffee with ED is designed to close that gap — a relaxed, informal sit-down with our Executive Directors, away from the structure of a chapter meeting.

### *A Direct Line to Leadership*

New members rarely get unfiltered, one-on-one time with the people who've built this ecosystem over 12 years. This session gives them exactly that — no agenda, just conversation. It creates space to understand the people behind the network and to ask questions openly.

### *Context, Not Just Content*

Training teaches the mechanics of BNI. Coffee with ED gives new members the why — the philosophy behind referral marketing, and how to actually make it work for their business. That context helps members move beyond simply attending meetings and begin participating with purpose.

### *A Sense of Belonging, Early*

Members who feel personally welcomed in their first 90 days stay engaged far longer than those who don't. A conversation over coffee does more for retention than any onboarding email. It helps new members feel seen, connected and confident from the beginning.

### *Real Answers to Real Hesitations*

New members often hold back their honest questions in group settings. Over coffee, those questions finally get asked — and answered. Whether they are unsure about referrals, networking or finding their place within the chapter, the conversation offers clarity without pressure.

> ***"It's a small gesture with outsized impact: a warm welcome that turns a new member into a rooted one."***

In those early weeks, a simple conversation can make BNI feel less like a new environment to navigate and more like a community to belong to, for everyone involved.

*-Executive Director*
*Pankaj J Harwansh*

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